Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Thursday, 5 November 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Light drizzle	Overcast	Overcast	Overcast
11° 9°	10° 7°	11° 9°	11° 5°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **Passengers on a train attacked by a man with a knife initially thought the terrifying incident was a joke.**
The first victim of the mass attack described asking hospital staff if he was going to die. This serious incident has left many shaken and concerned.
CRIME · UK

2 **A British man infected with Ebola in the Democratic Republic of Congo is being flown back to the UK for treatment.**
Authorities say the wider risk to the British public from the deadly virus remains low. Medical teams are taking all necessary precautions.
HEALTH · UK

3 **Cocaine has tragically overtaken heroin as the leading cause of drug-related deaths in England and Wales.**
The number of deaths linked to cocaine use has nearly quadrupled over the last decade. This stark rise highlights a significant public health concern.
HEALTH · UK

4 **Police have launched an inquiry after two inmates sadly died in prison custody on Wednesday.**
The Ministry of Justice confirmed the deaths, which will now be thoroughly investigated. Such incidents always raise serious questions about prison safety.
JUSTICE · UK

5 **The UK government is set to outlaw new North Sea drilling, with Labour ministers publishing legislation to end new oil and gas licences.**
This move signals a significant shift in energy policy, aiming to transition away from fossil fuels. It's a decision that will spark much debate about energy security.
ENVIRONMENT · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **The Crown star Josh O'Connor says he's 'honoured' by speculation that he could be the next James Bond.**

The BAFTA-nominated actor is among the names being whispered as the next 007. Could we see him trading his royal duties for a licence to kill?

ON AIR — Who would you like to see as the next James Bond? Is Josh O'Connor a good fit?

FILM · COMING UP

2 **Bollywood superstar Ranbir Kapoor is opening up about AI, movies, and the joys of fatherhood.**

Kapoor is currently starring in a major new adaptation of the Indian epic, Ramayana. He's sharing insights into his busy life on and off-screen.

ON AIR — How do you think AI will change the film industry in the coming years?

FILM · NEW RELEASE

3 **James Blunt has revealed he tried – and failed – to get banished from the popular TV show 'The Traitors'.**

The singer-songwriter is giving us all the behind-the-scenes gossip from his time on the hit series. He also hints at new music on the horizon.

ON AIR — If you were on 'The Traitors', would you rather be a Faithful or a Traitor?

TV · COMING UP

4 **Fleabag creator Phoebe Waller-Bridge is offering a rent-free flat to new writers to help them break into the industry.**

The acclaimed star is donating accommodation to playwrights from underprivileged backgrounds. It's a wonderful initiative to support emerging talent.

ON AIR — What's the best creative opportunity you've ever been given?

THEATRE · GOOD NEWS

5 **Kim Kardashian has explained why she returned to 'the worst TV drama ever' for its second series.**

The media personality says she's been working on her acting skills for 'All's Fair'. She's clearly determined to prove her critics wrong!

ON AIR — Are there any TV shows you secretly love, even if they're not critically acclaimed?

TV · NEW RELEASE

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **American boxing star Deontay Wilder is set to fight Australia's Jai Opetaia on the undercard of the huge Tyson Fury versus Anthony Joshua bout.**

The highly anticipated fight night is scheduled for December at Cardiff's Principality Stadium. It promises to be an epic evening of boxing.

ON AIR — Who are you backing in the big Fury vs Joshua fight, and will Wilder add to the excitement?

BOXING · UK

2 **Ireland has announced their starting XV for the Nations Championship clash against Argentina on Friday night.**

Nick Timoney, Craig Casey, and Sean Jansen are all set to start at the Aviva Stadium. It's a big game for the Irish as they look to assert their dominance.

ON AIR — Are you excited for the Nations Championship this weekend? Who do you think will come out on top?

RUGBY · UK

3 **British teenager Mika Stojsavljevic has claimed her first WTA Tour main-draw win, beating former Australian Open champion Sofia Kenin.**

The 17-year-old achieved the impressive feat despite being called up at short notice. What a brilliant start to her professional career!

ON AIR — Who are the young British sports stars you're most excited about right now?

TENNIS · UK

4 **England's Rugby Football Union chief executive Bill Sweeney is demanding more discipline from the card-happy England squad.**

He says England are the second-best side in the world when they can keep 15 players on the pitch. It's a clear message to the team ahead of upcoming matches.

ON AIR — Do you think England's discipline is their biggest weakness in rugby right now?

RUGBY · UK

5 **Jake Paul has declared he will retire from boxing if he loses to MMA star Cedric Doumbe in their December 24th fight in Dubai.**

The YouTube sensation is putting his boxing career on the line in what promises to be an explosive encounter. It's a bold statement from Paul.

ON AIR — Do you think Jake Paul will actually retire if he loses, or is it just pre-fight hype?

BOXING · INTERNATIONAL

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **A new study reveals that the sound of a well-maintained garden gate gently closing brings a surprising sense of contentment to many.**
Researchers suggest this subtle auditory cue is linked to feelings of home security and the peaceful end to an outdoor task, acting as a small, daily comfort.

2 **The simple act of 'aligning items in the fridge' is being hailed as a surprising stress-reducer.**
Organising groceries into neat rows or by colour is providing unexpected calm and a small sense of accomplishment in a busy day, according to lifestyle experts.

3 **Many are discovering the unexpected joy in 'spotting a perfectly symmetrical puddle' after a rain shower.**
This fleeting natural mirror is offering a moment of quiet appreciation for the small, beautiful accidents of everyday life, turning a mundane walk into a mini art hunt.

4 **A peculiar trend sees individuals meticulously 'colour-matching their socks after laundry'.**
Far from a chore, this task is becoming a meditative ritual for some, providing a sense of order and completion before putting them away.

5 **The comforting aroma of 'toasting bread, just before it pops up' is gaining recognition as a beloved scent.**
This anticipation of breakfast, coupled with the warm, yeasty smell, is being cited as a small but significant moment of daily pleasure and nostalgia for many.

6 **A recent informal poll suggests that the 'satisfying click of a perfectly fitting lid on a storage container' is a universal mini-triumph.**
This small, everyday success brings an unexpected sense of efficiency and order to kitchen cupboards, creating a quiet moment of gratification.

7 **More people are finding unexpected delight in 'watching a kettle come to a rolling boil'.**
The mesmerising bubbles and rising steam offer a simple, calming moment of anticipation before making a comforting hot drink, a small pause in a busy schedule.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to discreetly 'doing' what when we're trying to figure out if a new plant in a shop is healthy, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?**

ANSWER: GENTLY TOUCHING A LEAF TO SEE IF IT 'FEELS' RIGHT.

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new bar of soap, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: SMELLING IT AT LEAST THREE TIMES BEFORE UNWRAPPING IT.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you hear a particular 'old tune' and it instantly transports you back to a very specific moment or place from your past?**
  What's that song for you, and where does it take you back to?

- **We all have that 'one particular kitchen utensil' that we absolutely swear by and couldn't live without, even if it's a bit old or quirky.**
  What's your irreplaceable kitchen tool, and why is it so special?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a parliament.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Penguins have a special gland that allows them to drink seawater.

Prepflow

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The shortest war in history lasted only 38 to 45 minutes between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.
- Bananaphobia is the fear of bananas.
- The world's largest snowflake on record was 15 inches wide and 8 inches thick, observed in Montana in 1887.
- Oxford University is older than the Aztec Empire.
- A cloud can weigh over a million pounds.
- The 'richest' bird in the world is the weaver bird, which builds incredibly intricate nests.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES THU 5 NOV 2026

On this day

Day 309 of the year, 56 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: All Jesuit Saints and Blesseds; Christian feast day: Saint Domninus of Grenoble; Christian feast day: Blessed Bernhard Lichtenberg; Christian feast day: Berthild of Chelles. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Topaz.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1985 — Annet Mahendru, American actress
- 1969 — Pat Kilbane, American actor, comedian, director and screenwriter
- 1975 — Lisa Scott-Lee, Welsh singer-songwriter
- 1938 — Joe Dassin, American-French singer-songwriter (died 1980)
- 1947 — Peter Noone, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1941 — Art Garfunkel, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1976 — Sebastian Arcelus, American actor
- 1963 — Tatum O'Neal, American actress and author

THE DAY TODAY

- 2009 — U.S. Army Major Nidal Hasan murders 13 and wounds 32 at Fort Hood, Texas in the deadliest mass shooting at a U.S. military installation.
- 2013 — India launches the Mars Orbiter Mission, its first interplanetary probe.
- 1943 — World War II: Bombing of the Vatican.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2006 — Saddam Hussein, the former president of Iraq, and his co-defendants Barzan Ibrahim al-Tikriti and Awad Hamed al-Bandar, are sentenced to death in the al-Dujail trial for their roles in the 1982 massacre of 148 Shia Muslims.
- 2007 — China's first lunar satellite, Chang'e 1, goes into orbit around the Moon.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2015 — Rona Ambrose takes over after Stephen Harper as the Leader of the Conservative Party of Canada.
- 2007 — The Android mobile operating system is unveiled by Google.

- 1983 — The Byford Dolphin diving bell accident kills five and leaves one severely injured.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES FRI 6 NOV 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 310 of the year, 55 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast days: Barlaam of Khutyn; Christian feast days: Blessed Christina von Stommeln; Christian feast days: Demetrian; Christian feast days: Illtud. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Topaz.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1926 — Frank Carson, Northern Irish comedian and actor (died 2012)
- 1949 — Elwood Edwards, American voice actor (died 2024)
- 1990 — Bowen Yang, Australian-born American actor, comedian, podcaster, and writer
- 1960 — Lance Kerwin, American actor (died 2023)
- 1986 — Conor Sammon, Irish footballer
- 1972 — Rebecca Romijn, American model and actress
- 1952 — Michael Cunningham, American novelist and screenwriter
- 1963 — Rozz Williams, American singer, musician and artist (died 1998)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2025 — Canadian ostrich cull: The Government of Canada kills 314 ostriches after H5N8 is detected in an ostrich farm in Edgewood, BC.
- 1869 — In New Brunswick, New Jersey, Rutgers College defeats Princeton University (then known as the College of New Jersey), 6–4, in the first official intercollegiate American football game.
- 1976 — Uttawar forced sterilisations: Mass vasectomy of nearly 800 men of Uttawar village, Palwal district, Haryana during India's Emergency imposed by Indira Gandhi.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1217 — The Charter of the Forest is sealed at St Paul's Cathedral, London by King Henry III, acting under the regency of William Marshall, 1st Earl of Pembroke which re-establishes for free men rights of access to the royal forest that had been eroded by William the Conqueror and his...
- 1860 — Abraham Lincoln is elected the 16th president of the United States with only 40% of the popular vote, defeating John C. Breckinridge, John Bell, and Stephen A. Douglas in a four-way race.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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